

## Study Questions: Learning — How Circles Preserve and Pass On Craft

1. Explain **legitimate peripheral participation** in the context of a crochet circle. How does a newcomer move from the periphery to full participation?
2. Why does the word "legitimate" matter in legitimate peripheral participation? What happens if a newcomer's peripheral participation is not accepted by the group?
3. Describe the **generative model** of a newcomer on their first day at the circle. What predictions can they make? What is the source of their prediction error?
4. How does **observational learning** work before a newcomer ever picks up a hook? What specific kinds of observations build their generative model?
5. A newcomer watches an experienced crocheter's hands for several meetings before trying a stitch themselves. When they finally attempt it, they are "not starting from zero." Explain why, using Active Inference concepts.
6. Describe the trajectory of a circle member's generative model from newcomer to full participant over the course of a year. What changes in depth, breadth, and precision?
7. How does **cultural transmission** across generations work in crochet? What is being transmitted, in Active Inference terms?
8. When a daughter learns her mother's granny square technique but modifies the colors, what has happened to the generative model in transmission? Is this modification a loss or a gain?
9. What does it mean for a technique to be **lost** — to die with its last practitioner? Frame this in terms of generative model dissolution.
10. How can a **revival** of a lost technique happen? What role do old pattern books, the internet, and crochet circles play in re-establishing a dissolved generative model?

11. Identify the four features that make a crochet circle an effective learning environment (safety, scaffolding, diversity, continuity) and explain how each supports learning in Active Inference terms.
12. How does **normalizing errors** (celebrating frogging, treating mistakes as learning) reduce the social cost of prediction error? What would happen in a circle where errors were stigmatized?
13. Explain **scaffolding** in a crochet circle. Give an example of how an experienced member provides just enough support without taking over the learner's project.
14. How does the **diversity of skill levels** create a zone of proximal development? Why is this more effective for learning than a group of all beginners or all experts?
15. What role does **continuity** (meeting regularly) play in learning? How does the weekly rhythm of meetings relate to the prediction-action-error-update cycle of Active Inference?
16. Describe the "grandmother effect" in crochet transmission. Why does the generative model sometimes skip a generation?
17. How does the **internet** extend the learning mechanisms of the physical circle? What does it add, and what does it lack compared to in-person learning?
18. A long-time member of the circle learns a new technique from a YouTube video and brings it back to the group. Trace the flow of this generative model from online community to individual to circle.
19. How does a circle's learning capacity change over time as the group accumulates shared experience? Is there a point at which the group's learning slows down? What could reinvigorate it?
20. Reflect on your own crochet learning history. Who were the key people or communities that shaped your generative model? How does your model carry traces of the people who taught you?